



Economics 313

Intermediate Macroeconomics

Summer 2026

Course Section: 001

Meeting Time and Place: 2:00 – 3:25, online via Zoom

Course Credit Hours: 3

Faculty Contact Information

Instructor: Pengzhen Li

Office: Cherokee Mills, room no. F154

Office Hours: 12–2 and by appointment

Email: pli26@vols.utk.edu

Meeting Link: <https://tennessee.zoom.us/j/8266363841>

Course Description

(from course catalog): Measurement of income and prices, aggregate demand, output, employment, price determination, inflation, business fluctuations, fiscal and monetary policies and growth.

Value of the Course

Macroeconomic models influence governmental policy, central bank decisions, firm decision making, and individual investment strategies. In this course, we will develop simple mathematical and graphical models to explain real world phenomena. These models will further develop students' economic intuition, inform students' views on macroeconomic policy, and build a basis for more advanced economic courses.

Required Text

Macroeconomics, N. Gregory Mankiw, 12th Edition.

Prerequisites

ECON 201 or ECON 207 and Statistics 201 or 207.

Student Learning Outcomes / Objectives

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Describe measures of macroeconomic health.
- Model markets with simple supply and demand graphs.
- Identify the components of national income.
- Analyze changes in market equilibrium using Classical economic theory.
- Describe the role of the monetary system in economic policy.
- Compare tradeoffs of inflation and economic growth.

- Categorize types of unemployment and their role in a healthy economy.
- Model economic changes through the IS-LM model.
- Contrast tradeoffs between inflation and unemployment.
- Describe economic policy tools available to countries.
- Judge pros and cons of macroeconomic policies.

Learning Environment

To facilitate learning for everyone in the class, the following are guidelines to behave professionally and respectfully in this class. Learning is not something that you can be forced to do. It is expected that you approach class with an openness to new ideas, enhance the learning environment of others around you, and take responsibility for your own learning.

Student's Responsibility

- Attend and be prepared for all classes
- Respect class time by arriving before 2:00
- Treat others with kindness and respect
- Actively contribute to the learning activities in class
- Ask questions about concepts or material that is unclear
- Abide by the UT Honor Code

Instructor's Responsibility

- Be prepared for all classes
- Respect class time by concluding class at 3:25
- Create and facilitate meaningful learning activities
- Evaluate all fairly and equally
- Be respectful and kind to all students
- Behave according to University codes of conduct

Technology in Class

Technology use has rapidly changed over recent years, and expectations in this class will reflect this. You will not need any technology for a typical class, and I will let you know ahead of time if computers or other types of technology are needed for a class. You are welcome to use any technological device that assists in your learning so long as it does not disrupt others' learning.

Course Resources

This class will use Canvas as the primary location for all class files and assignments. Communication regarding changes to the course or reminders will occur in Canvas announcements.

Grading and Evaluation Policies

End of Chapter Problems – Practice (10%):

Delivered through Canvas. **Unlimited attempts**; only the *last* attempt is recorded. Work through these to master the material at your own pace.

End of Chapter Problems – Graded (10%):

Delivered through Canvas. **One attempt only**; the score on that single attempt counts toward your grade. Solutions are released after the due date. The questions are similar in style to the

practice version – complete the practice version first.

Assignments (20%):

There will be four assignments (HW1–HW4), each worth 5% of your final grade. Each assignment combines two parts:

- **Computational problems** on the chapters covered, similar in style to the End of Chapter problems but requiring full written derivations.
- **Current-events memo** (400–600 words): you locate a recent news article on a macroeconomic topic (GDP/CPI release, jobs report, FOMC decision, Phillips curve, government debt, or banking) and write a short analysis that (i) summarizes the headline numbers with proper citation, (ii) connects the article to the chapter’s model, and (iii) performs at least one *quantitative* check using primary data (BEA, BLS, FRED, CBO, FDIC). Each assignment specifies the topic and grading rubric.

Exams (50%):

There will be a total of three exams for this course: two midterms and a final. The two midterm exams will each be worth 15% of your final grade. The final exam will be worth 20% of your grade.

Attendance / Participation (10%):

Students will be expected to participate during in-class assessments and discussions. This assessment may take the form of in-class worksheets, exit quizzes, or participation in class discussions. If you miss a class, it is your responsibility to get notes from a classmate.

Grading Scale

End of Chapter Problems – Practice:	10%
End of Chapter Problems – Graded:	10%
Assignments:	20%
Exam 1:	15%
Exam 2:	15%
Final Exam:	20%
In-class participation:	10%
Total	100%

Final Course Letter Grades

Course Percentage	Letter Grade
92.0% – 100%	A
90.0% – 91.99%	A–
88.0% – 89.99%	B+
82.0% – 87.99%	B
80.0% – 81.99%	B–
78.0% – 79.99%	C+
72.0% – 77.99%	C
70.0% – 71.99%	C–
68.0% – 69.99%	D+
62.0% – 67.99%	D
60.0% – 61.99%	D–
Less than 59.99%	F

Copyright Policy

The instructor of this class owns the copyright to the syllabus, handouts, assignments, quizzes, and exams associated with the class. All presentations developed by the instructor, as well as the instructor's lectures, are also protected by copyright, whether these presentations and lectures are delivered live in-class, shared through Zoom or other video conference platforms, or uploaded to Canvas or similar sites.

Sharing any of this material without the written permission of the instructor is a violation of copyright law and is therefore also a violation of the University's policy on acceptable use of information technology resources (UT policy number IT0110). That policy states that students will not commit copyright infringement, "including file sharing of video, audio, or data without permission from the copyright owner", and that file sharing is a violation of the university's student code of conduct. I will report all such violations to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards.

Tentative Course Outline

Date	Content	Chapter
07/07	The Science of Macroeconomics	Ch 1
07/08	The Data of Macroeconomics	Ch 2
07/09	National Income: How It Is Earned	Ch 3
07/10	National Income: How It Is Spent	Ch 4
07/13	Monetary System	Ch 5
07/14	Inflation	Ch 6
07/15	The Open Economy	Ch 7
07/16	Exam 1 Review	
07/17	Exam 1	
07/20	Unemployment and the Labor Market	Ch 8
07/21	Solow Growth Model	Ch 09
07/22	Solow Growth Model	Ch 09
07/23	Population Growth	Ch 10
07/24	Economic Fluctuations	Ch 12
07/27	Exam 2	
07/28	Aggregate Demand	Ch 13
07/29	Aggregate Demand	Ch 14
07/30	Aggregate Demand	Ch 14
07/31	The Open Economy Revisited	Ch 15
08/03	Aggregate Supply	Ch 16
08/04	Aggregate Supply + Review	Ch 16
08/05	Government Debt	Ch 19
08/06	Banking and Monetary System	Ch 20
08/07	Financial System	Ch 21
08/10	Final Exam Review	
08/11	Final Exam	
*subject to change		

Academic Integrity

Each student is responsible for abiding by the policies and honor code set forth in UT Hill Topics regarding academic integrity. Cheating of any sort including plagiarism will not be tolerated and will result in a grade of F for the course and charge filed with the Dean of Students. It is recognized that any student has the right to appeal a grading decision of an instructor and/or penalties resulting from a charge of academic dishonesty.

UT honor code statement:

“As a student of the University, I pledge that I will neither knowingly give nor receive any inappropriate assistance in academic work, thus affirming my own personal commitment to honor and integrity.”

Disability

Any student who feels s/he may need an accommodation based on the impact of a disability should contact the instructor privately to discuss specific needs. Please contact the Office of Disability Services at 865-974-6087 in Hoskins Library to coordinate reasonable accommodations for students with documented disabilities.

University Civility Statement

Civility is genuine respect and regard for others: politeness, consideration, tact, good manners, graciousness, cordiality, affability, amiability and courteousness. Civility enhances academic freedom and integrity, and is a prerequisite to the free exchange of ideas and knowledge in the learning community. Our community consists of students, faculty, staff, alumni, and campus visitors. Community members affect each other's well-being and have a shared interest in creating and sustaining an environment where all community members and their points of view are valued and respected. Affirming the value of each member of the university community, the campus asks that all its members adhere to the principles of civility and community adopted by the campus: <http://civility.utk.edu/>.

Key Campus Resources for Students

- [Center for Career Development and Academic Exploration](#) (Career counseling and resources; Handshake job search system)
- [Course Catalogs](#) (Listing of academic programs, courses, and policies)
- [Hilltopics](#) (Campus and academic policies, procedures and standards of conduct)
- [OIT HelpDesk](#) (865) 974-9900
- [Schedule of Classes / Timetable](#)
- [Student Health Center](#) (visit the site for a list of services)
- [Academic Success Center](#) (Academic support resources)
- [Undergraduate Academic Advising](#) (Advising resources, course requirements, and major guides)
- [University Libraries](#) (Access to library resources, databases, course reserves, and services)

Wellness

wellness.utk.edu and counselingcenter.utk.edu

The [Center for Health Education and Wellness](#) empowers all Volunteers to thrive by cultivating personal and community well-being. The Center can answer questions about general wellness, substance use, sexual health, healthy relationships, and sexual assault prevention. The [Student Counseling Center](#) is the university's primary facility for personal counseling, psychotherapy, and psychological outreach and consultation services.

Any student who has difficulty affording hygiene products, groceries, or accessing sufficient food to eat every day is urged to contact the [Big Orange Pantry](#) for support. The Big Orange Pantry, located in Greve Hall, is a free resource for all students, faculty, and staff, no matter how great or small their need is. Students who need emergency financial assistance can also request funding from the [Student Emergency Fund](#).

Students who are experiencing non-academic difficulty or distress and need assistance should call 974-HELP or [submit an online referral](#). The 974-HELP team specializes in aligning resources and support to students experiencing mental health distress.

Your Role in Improving the Course Through Assessment

At UT, it is our collective responsibility to improve the state of teaching and learning. During the semester you may be requested to assess aspects of this course, either during class or at the completion of the class, and through the TNVoice course evaluation. Please take the few moments needed to respond to these requests as they are used by instructors, department heads, deans and others to improve the quality of your UT learning experience.

The instructor reserves the right to revise, alter or amend this syllabus as necessary. Students will be notified in writing / email of any such changes.